

the years has not been as per our expectations, which is why there has been a change in the entire scheme of things. Sony decided to part ways with Ericsson and form its Sony Mobile division with an aim to focus and offer products that will reflect the company's persona. The market position is merely a number; what we would like to aim for is to satisfy consumers with our products and not worry about our position. With Xperia Z and other upcoming models, we believe there is enough capability in the brand to compete with the heavyweights.

Q: What is your market position in the Indian market and globally?

Sony does not disclose market share figures but, as per reports, Sony has a 9 per cent market share in the Indian smartphone segment. Ideally, we would like the figure to be around 15 to 20 per cent in the coming years and we hope that our latest premium offerings in the Xperia series will be able to deliver that. Globally, our positions vary in different markets but overall, we are No 1 in Japan and in some parts of Europe and we'd like to have a similar position in other markets as well. This year, Sony will focus on being a premium brand, which was not the case last year, and offer products across different price points.

Q: Sony is not visible in the smart camera segment. Are there any plans to introduce products in the segment?

Smart cameras primarily revolve around connectivity. Sony has the highest number of NFC-enabled products in the world. Before summer, we will have more than 35 NFC-based models in our portfolio that will offer Wi-Fi support for seamless connectivity and sharing.

Q: How do you plan to engage with consumers in the country?

For Sony, reaching out to consumers has always been essential and it will remain the same with the Xperia smartphones as well. We already have a wide network of sellers present across the country. We will be adding over 300 touch points as well



"If the Firefox OS is able to succeed in the market and offer a premium user-experience, then we would engage with the company more deeply"

and our marketing investments will be to the tune of Rs 3 billion for this year. We'll be focusing on ATL activities, online and social media as well. But the touch point is the place where the customer goes and experiences the product before buying, which is why we have to communicate our value proposition in the right manner. There will be demonstrations that will be held in malls and big venues. We will target the top metro cities and move to other sections later.

Q: This year's Union Budget included an excise duty for smartphones costing above Rs 2,000. How does that affect Sony Mobile's pricing strategy from here on?

We have come to terms with the recent budget announcement that included an excise duty hike on phones costing more than Rs 2,000. We will be discussing this in our upcoming corporate meetings and come to a conclusion that will satisfy both the brand managers and the consumers.

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